

Ms Jennifer Arkell
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Resident in London

Personal profile of Jennifer Arkell

I am a motivated, self-sufficient trainee solicitor, looking to progress my legal career with an NQ position in finance. I am someone who delights in intellectual challenges and flourishes in an environment where I constantly have the opportunity to learn alongside likeminded, energetic people. Qualities that distinguish me are that I am responsible, self-confident and organised.

I've worked in various paralegal positions in a variety of private practice, public sector and legal aid roles, most recently as a corporate paralegal at RPC before starting my training contract at HCR Law. I'm currently undertaking my period of recognised training and I am now looking for the next step as an NQ. My ideal position would be somewhere I can learn from excellent seniors, gain valuable experience with a variety of clients and gain confidence and esteem as I build my personal brand as a qualified solicitor.

Education

2020 – 2022	University of Law – i-LPC with MSc in Law, Business and Management (part-time) – Distinction. <i>Elective modules: Banking and Debt Finance Law & Practice, Intellectual Property Law & Practice, Public Companies Law & Practice</i>
2019 – 2020	Oxford Brookes University – GDL – Distinction. <i>Dissertation: 'An Evaluation of the Current Law Governing Commercial Space Tourism in the UK'</i>
2015 – 2018	University of Bristol - BSc Chemistry 2:2
2013 – 2015	Headington School (Biology, Maths, Chemistry (A2); Economics (AS) (AABA)) Additional: Academic Scholar
2008 - 2013	Headington School (12 GCSE's) – 8 A* and 4 A (including Maths and English)

Work experience

Sep 2023 – Sep 2025	Period of recognised training at HCR <i>PSC electives: Stock Markets & Flotations, Corporate Tax Transactions, Company Accounts and Corporate Drafting</i>
<i>Seat 1 – International Commercial (Supervisor: Nicolas Groffman)</i>	During my seat in International Commercial, I was fortunate to experience a diverse practice including work in media, defence, sports, data protection, charity, regulations of law firms and partnerships.
<i>Seat 2 – Family Law (Supervisor: Kate Grant)</i>	Variety of family cases, including divorce, child arrangements, forced marriage, marital finances (include business and property portfolio valuations and divisions, pensions and inheritance), pre and post nuptial agreements and relocation cases.
<i>Seat 3 – Banking (Supervisor: Harry Bengough)</i>	During my Banking and Finance seat I had the opportunity to work on a wide variety of deals with some superb, experienced seniors. The banking team at HCR specialises in lower midmarket deals up to c. £50 million, working with a spectrum of banks on a variety of leveraged deals as part of initial financings, refinancings, accessions and amendment and restatements. This covered a variety of facilities including term, revolving and invoice financing. I also gained experience on some real estate finance matters. Key development points were: Drafting - Drafting and maintaining conditions precedent checklists - Drafting corporate authorisations for a variety of transactions of various complexities (including: board minutes, resolutions, articles of association with secured institution wording and directors certificates) - Drafting, managing and supplying of information required as part of the conditions precedent process - Drafting various deeds of release, deeds of amendment and deeds of accession - Drafting pay-off letters

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- Drafting notices and managing the delivery of said notices
- Drafting certificates of independent legal advice as part of the provision of independent legal advice
- Drafting loan agreements for subordinated debt as part of a refinancing agreement
- Drafting security documentation based on internal and lender precedents including legal charges, debentures, share charges, deeds of rental assignment and subordination deeds

Communication:

- Liaising with lenders and borrowers to facilitate completions
- Inter-departmental communications, e.g. with corporate or real estate
- Coordinating signing and delivery of both lender side and borrower side documents as part of completion
- Negotiation with opposing counsel as to the form and delivery of conditions precedent
- Liaising with international counsel on cross border transactions including Swedish, Jersey and Scottish counsel
- Liaising with property teams as to security filings at the land registry

Presenting and attendance:

- Case law updates at team meetings which required diligent research into new relevant case law
- Preparation of presentations to lender clients
- Attending completion calls

Miscellaneous

- Post completion activities including: bibles, post completion checklists, supplying and managing conditions subsequent, companies house filings and organising legal opinions
- Review of bond issue documentation
- Managing the safe keeping and delivery of original documents
- Companies house due diligence on group companies
- Security filings at Companies House
- Preparation and delivery of undated stock transfer forms

*Seat 4 – Corporate
(Supervisor: Lara Bethell)*

In my short time in the corporate department, I have been pleased to find that I immediately felt incredibly at home, and that my past experiences as a corporate paralegal at various firms prior to starting my training contract has stood me in excellent stead. I have been working on a variety of matters, mainly for private equity clients.

Drafting

- SPA and APA ancillaries
- Board minutes
- Documents lists
- Share buyback documentation and agreements
- Drafting SPAs based on my review of the initial draft
- Preparation of due diligence questionnaires
- Compliance letters and letters to shareholders
- Companies house forms

Communication

- Attending calls with clients on various matters
- Hosting in person and virtual client meetings independently for various ancillary matters
- Liaising and negotiating with the opposing side on various APA/SPA transactions

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- Liaising with various teams across the firm as part of the due diligence process

Miscellaneous

- Researching various matters prior to the drafting of documents lists, share buyback documentation, and due diligence questionnaires and reports.
- Companies house filings from the standard CS01s to the more obscure e.g. RP04s and OS CH01s and post completion filings
- Review of constitutional documents for provisions ahead of dividend distribution
- Preparation of bibles
- Organising stamp duty payments
- Company incorporations
- Updating statutory books
- Managing data rooms
- Review of SPAs

I look forward to building on my experience over the last few months of my training contract.

Feb 2023 – present

Strut Safe - Call handler volunteer

- Strut Safe is a non-profit organisation dedicated to providing a free, non-judgemental escort telephone service for women, queer people, people of colour, and anyone who needs to feel safe walking home

Oct 2022 – June 2023

RPC - Corporate paralegal (including non-contentious construction)

Feb 2022 – Aug 2022

Taylor Vinters (now Mishcon de Reya) - Corporate paralegal

April 2021 – Feb 2022

Competition and Markets Authority - Litigation paralegal

June 2020 – March 2021

SMQ Legal Services Oxford – Family/criminal/civil paralegal

April 2014 – April 2021

Various positions including waitressing, bartending, sales, stable work, work experience, shadowing and volunteering in-between studies

Interests

- Horse riding has been a lifelong passion of mine; I had my own horse until recently and I continue to ride with friends at the weekend.
- I'm an avid reader of classic fiction and non-fiction around my interests.
- I'm a keen amateur chef and I enjoy preparing dishes for friends and colleagues.

References available on request